



FLIP THROUGH BEFORE YOU DOWNLOAD

AI Feedback That Cannot Cost a Grade

Three real pages, straight off the shipping files, plus everything the full download includes.



RULE 1

It saves first, and speaks second

The student presses submit. **The answer is written down.** Only then does the coach appear. In that order, always, and the order is the whole rule.

What the default build does instead

It reads the work, decides it is not ready, and **holds the submit button hostage until the student fixes what it flagged.** It feels helpful when you demonstrate it. In a real room it means a student who has finished cannot hand in, with four minutes left, because software has an opinion about a comma.

Three things that go wrong when the tool can block

Work gets lost. The student who cannot submit closes the tab. Nothing you say afterward gets that back.

The student starts writing for the tool. Short, safe, mechanically clean sentences get through the gate fastest, so that is what you receive. You have optimized for the checker and taught nothing

Its opinion never touches the mark

Mechanics are excluded from every score in my software. The coach can say a sentence is a fragment. It cannot cost a single point for saying so, and the student is told that.

Why this is not softness

A mark is a claim about whether a student understood something. **The moment spelling moves it, the mark is partly a claim about spelling** and you can no longer read it as evidence of understanding. Separating them is not lowering a standard; it is keeping the number meaningful. Mark the mechanics separately if you need to — just not in the same number.

And there is evidence that a comment next to a score does nothing

Ruth Butler's 1988 study put 132 fifth and sixth graders into three conditions: **grades only, comments only, or both**. Interest and performance were generally higher after comments than after grades alone or grades with comments.

Eight questions before it reads student writing

Most teachers will never build this; they will be handed one. **These are the eight questions to ask, and the answers you want.** Ask them of the sales page, then of the tool.

#	Ask	The answer you want
1	Can a student submit while the tool is still unhappy with the work?	Yes, always. If no, stop here.
2	Is the work saved before the feedback runs?	Yes , and it can be shown.
3	Does anything the tool says change a score anywhere?	No. If yes, which scores, and can you switch it off?
4	How many items does it return at once, and can you cap it?	A cap you control, and a small default .
5	Is student writing used to train a model?	No , in writing, in the contract.
6	Who else can read the feedback it gives a student?	No



WHAT IS INSIDE

AI Feedback That Cannot Cost a Grade

- ✓ **Rule 1: it saves first and speaks second**
- ✓ Three things that go wrong when a tool can block a submission
- ✓ **Rule 2: its opinion never touches the mark**
- ✓ What the research says, with the caveat usually left out
- ✓ **Rule 3: three things, not everything**
- ✓ **Eight questions** for an AI tool you did not build

Running it with your whole staff? Additional teacher licenses are just \$0, and we accept purchase orders through TpT for Schools.

